



SAFETY TOOLBOX TALK

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Topic:			Operating an Excavator on Slopes / Mounds / Stockpiles		

This briefing is not intended to tell you how to do your jobs, it is designed to help keep you safe. We want everybody to be able to return home safely to their family and friends at the end of each day.

Excavators encounter a variety of conditions in their work, of which steep slopes are the most common, but how can the excavator quickly and safely go up and down various slopes?

Uphill and Downhill

- 1) When driving down a steep slope, use a walking joystick and a throttle joystick to keep the driving speed low. When driving upward or downward on slopes or mounds exceeding 15 degrees, the angle between the arm and the boom should be 90 ~ 110 degrees, the distance from the back of the bucket to the ground is 20 ~ 30cm, and the engine speed is reduced.
- 2) If braking is required when going downhill, put the walking joystick in the neutral position so that the brake will automatically work.
- 3) When walking on an uphill slope, if the track shoe slips, in addition to relying on the driving force of the track shoe to drive uphill, the pulling force of the stick should be used to help the machine go uphill.
- 4) If the engine goes off when going uphill, you can move the walking joystick to the neutral position, lower the bucket to the ground, stop the machine, and then start the engine.
- 5) The engine is turned off on the slope, and the turning operation is prohibited to prevent the superstructure from turning under its own weight.
- 6) If the machine is parked on a slope, do not open the cab door. This will easily cause sudden changes in operating force. The cab door should always be closed.
- 7) When walking on a slope, do not change the walking direction, otherwise it will cause the machine to tip over or slip. If you must change direction on a slope, you should operate on a gentler, firmer slope.
- 8) Avoid crossing slopes as this may cause the machine to slip.
- 9) When working on a slope, do not turn it, because it is easy to cause the machine to tip over and slip because it is out of balance. Rotate and operate the boom carefully at low speeds.
- 10) A seatbelt must be worn at all times when operating an Excavator



Discussion Points

What could happen if you drive across a slope?